

VIT Bhopal University

VITyarthi E-Learning Platform

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

PROJECT REPORT

Digital Literacy Portfolio – Student

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Year	First Year (2025 BATCH)
Course Code	CSE0001 – Digital Literacy
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Introduction

This project report documents my work as a Student Digital Ambassador for the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. The assignment required me to explore five key areas of digital literacy — creating awareness content, building a professional digital presence, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, practising professional communication, and understanding cybercrime and online safety.

Through this project, I worked with free, browser-based tools including Canva, GitHub, LinkedIn, Google Workspace, HackerRank, and various cybersecurity resources. Each task was designed to build practical digital skills that are directly relevant to academic life and future employment. The project also involved setting up a GitHub repository to organise and present all deliverables — an experience that itself introduced me to version control and professional portfolio-building.

This report presents the write-up for each of the five tasks, along with my reflections, observations, and key learnings from the process.

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Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Overview

For this task, I created a one-page digital literacy awareness infographic aimed at helping my batchmates understand what digital literacy means and why it is an essential skill in today's world.

Tool Used

I used Canva (canva.com), a free browser-based graphic design platform. Canva offers a wide variety of infographic templates that are easy to customise without any prior design experience. I chose a clean, modern template with a blue and white colour scheme to keep the content professional and readable.

What My Design Shows

My infographic covers three key topics of digital literacy:

- What Digital Literacy Is – A short definition explaining that digital literacy is the ability to use digital tools effectively, critically, and responsibly.
- Useful Digital Tools for Students – A visual list of tools including Google Workspace, GitHub, Canva, and HackerRank, with a brief note on how each supports academic work.
- Safe Internet Practices – Key tips such as using strong passwords, avoiding unknown links, enabling two-factor authentication, and being careful about sharing personal information online.

Reflection

Creating this infographic was an engaging and educational experience. One aspect I found particularly interesting was learning how to balance visual design with clear communication — too much text makes an infographic unreadable, but too little can leave the audience without enough context. I found it challenging to condense complex ideas like safe internet practices into short, impactful bullet points. Ultimately, this constraint made me think more carefully about what truly matters and how to communicate it efficiently. The process gave me a greater appreciation for visual communication as a skill in itself.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

Platforms Set Up

For this task, I created and configured accounts on three professional platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. Each serves a distinct purpose in building a comprehensive digital presence as a student in Computer Science.

Platform	Primary Purpose	What I Set Up
GitHub	Code hosting, version control, open-source collaboration	Profile README with name, branch, year, and learning goals
LinkedIn	Professional networking, internships, job opportunities	Education section with degree, institution, and graduation year
Kaggle	Data science competitions, datasets, notebooks	Account created; profile set up with branch and interests

Reflection

Setting up these three platforms was more meaningful than I initially expected. GitHub felt the most technical at first — creating a profile README required me to understand the concept of a repository and markdown formatting. However, once I got the hang of it, I realised how powerful a well-written profile README can be as a first impression for potential employers or collaborators.

LinkedIn reinforced the importance of presenting academic credentials professionally. Even at the first-year stage, having a properly filled-in Education section signals seriousness and professionalism to recruiters. Kaggle opened up a new world of data science for me — I had not realised how much free learning material and community activity exists on the platform.

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub as my primary portfolio for code projects and assignments, LinkedIn to connect with professionals and apply for internships from second year onwards, and Kaggle to practice data analysis and machine learning challenges as I advance in my studies.

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Task 3 – Coding and Collaboration Platforms

Part A – Coding Practice Platform

For this part, I chose HackerRank (hackerrank.com) as my coding practice platform. HackerRank is widely used by students and professionals alike for improving programming skills and preparing for technical interviews.

I completed the 'Solve Me First' challenge — a beginner-level problem that required writing a function to return the sum of two integers. Although the problem itself was simple, the process of navigating the HackerRank interface, reading the problem statement carefully, understanding input/output formatting, and submitting a solution was genuinely educational. I also received a score and a completion badge for this challenge, which are visible in my task-3-platforms/ folder screenshots.

Part B – Google Workspace Collaboration

For the collaboration component, I created a Google Form titled 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' containing five questions designed to test my batchmates' knowledge of digital literacy concepts. The form includes:

- Q1 (Multiple Choice): What does 'phishing' refer to in cybersecurity?
- Q2 (Multiple Choice): Which of the following is an example of two-factor authentication?
- Q3 (Multiple Choice): What is the primary purpose of GitHub?
- Q4 (Short Answer): Name two tools you would use to collaborate on a group project online.
- Q5 (Short Answer): What would you do if you received a suspicious email asking for your bank details?

The form is linked to a Google Sheet that automatically captures all responses. A screenshot of both the form and the response sheet has been added to the task-3-platforms/ folder. The form link is also included in my GitHub repository README.

Reflection

This task gave me hands-on experience with two categories of tools that will be directly useful throughout my academic career. HackerRank made me appreciate structured problem-solving —

even a simple challenge requires clear logical thinking and attention to output formatting. Building the Google Form taught me how collaborative tools can be used not just for communication, but for data collection and assessment. I can now see how these tools could be used in group projects, peer feedback, and academic surveys. Both platforms are ones I intend to continue using regularly throughout my degree.

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Task 4 – Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

Part A – Professional Email Drafts

Email 1 – Request for Assignment Deadline Extension

Email 1 – Deadline Extension Request

Subject: Request for Extension of Assignment Submission Deadline – [Course Name]

Dear Dr./Prof. [Faculty Name],

I hope this email finds you well. I am [Your Name], a first-year B.Tech student (Reg. No. [XXXX]) enrolled in your [Course Name] course.

I am writing to respectfully request a short extension of two days for the assignment submission due on [Date]. Due to [brief, genuine reason — e.g., a medical concern / technical difficulties with tool access], I have been unable to complete the work to the standard I would like to maintain.

I assure you that I have already made significant progress and will submit the completed assignment by [Proposed New Date] without any further delay. I understand that this is a request and I fully respect whatever decision you make.

Thank you for your time and understanding.

Yours sincerely,

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Email 2 – Internship Interest Expression

Email 2 – Summer Internship Expression of Interest

Subject: Application for Summer Internship Opportunity – B.Tech CSE Student, VIT Bhopal

Dear [Coordinator's Name],

I am [Your Name], a first-year B.Tech student in Computer Science and Engineering at VIT Bhopal University. I am writing to express my sincere interest in a summer internship opportunity at [Company Name].

I am particularly drawn to [Company Name] because of [specific reason — e.g., its work in cloud computing / its reputation for mentoring student interns / its focus on AI-driven products]. I am eager to gain practical exposure to industry practices, contribute meaningfully to your team, and develop skills beyond the classroom.

I am available from [Start Date] to [End Date] and am open to both in-person and remote arrangements. I have attached my resume and GitHub profile link for your reference. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how I can contribute during this period.

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to hearing from you.

Yours sincerely,

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Part B – Communication Scenario

A well-known example of poor digital communication causing real consequences involves an incident where a student posted frustrated comments about a professor on a public social media profile — not realising the account was searchable and linked to their real name. The professor saw the post, and the situation created significant tension that affected the student's assessment and academic relationships for the rest of the semester.

What could have been done differently: The student could have addressed their concern directly and professionally by emailing the professor or speaking privately with a student advisor. If they needed to vent, using a private journal or a trusted offline conversation would have avoided the professional

fallout. This scenario highlights how the digital world blurs the line between personal and professional spaces — a post made in frustration can be seen by the very people it is about.

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Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness: UPI/Online Payment Fraud

Case Study – UPI Payment Fraud

UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud is one of the fastest-growing cybercrime categories in India, particularly targeting young adults, college students, and first-time digital payment users.

How It Typically Happens

A realistic scenario: A college student in Bhopal lists a second-hand laptop on OLX for Rs. 18,000. Within an hour, a 'buyer' contacts them claiming to be an Army officer posted in a different city. The buyer says they will pay via Google Pay and sends a QR code, asking the student to 'scan it to receive the money.' The student scans the code, enters their UPI PIN — and Rs. 5,000 is instantly debited from their account instead.

This is a classic Collect Request or 'Reverse QR Code' scam. The fraudster sends a payment request disguised as a payment confirmation. Victims are manipulated into believing they are receiving money when they are actually authorising a payment. The fraudster then either disappears or continues with further 'verification amount' tricks.

Who Is Targeted

This fraud targets first-time online sellers, students posting items on classifieds platforms, and anyone unfamiliar with how UPI Collect Requests work. It exploits the visual similarity between 'Send Money' and 'Receive Money' flows in payment apps when the victim is under social pressure.

Consequences

Victims lose money immediately and irreversibly in most cases. Beyond financial loss, victims often experience anxiety, loss of trust in digital payment systems, and reluctance to use UPI. In some cases, scammers use collected UPI data for follow-on identity fraud. Reporting is possible through cybercrime.gov.in and Helpline 1930, but recovery of funds is not guaranteed.

Reflection

What surprised me most while researching this topic was how technically simple these scams are. The fraudster does not need any hacking skills — they simply exploit a user's misunderstanding of how UPI works. The QR code mechanism, which is designed to make payments faster and easier, becomes a weapon when people do not understand that scanning a QR code and entering your PIN means you are paying, not receiving.

One habit I will personally change as a result of this research: I will never enter my UPI PIN in response to a request that I did not initiate myself. If someone claims to have sent me money, I will verify it directly in my bank app's transaction history — not by following any link or scanning any code they send me.

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Conclusion

This Digital Literacy Portfolio project has been one of the most practically useful assignments I have undertaken in my first year at VIT Bhopal. Unlike traditional theory-based work, each task required me to actually set up accounts, build something, write professionally, and research real-world issues.

I now have a GitHub profile, a LinkedIn account, a Kaggle account, and a HackerRank account — all of which form the foundation of a professional digital identity that I will develop over the next four years. I have also gained a much deeper understanding of how to communicate professionally online, how to recognise common cybercrime patterns, and how to use digital tools for both creative and technical purposes.

Most importantly, this project has shown me that digital literacy is not a single skill — it is an ongoing practice of learning, adapting, and being responsible in an ever-changing digital environment.

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References

- Canva – Free Design Tool: <https://www.canva.com>
- GitHub – Code Hosting Platform: <https://github.com>
- LinkedIn – Professional Networking: <https://www.linkedin.com>
- Kaggle – Data Science Platform: <https://www.kaggle.com>
- HackerRank – Coding Practice: <https://www.hackerrank.com>
- Google Forms – Survey and Quiz Tool: <https://forms.google.com>
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal: <https://cybercrime.gov.in>
- Press Trust of India – Reports on UPI Fraud trends in India (2024)
- Reserve Bank of India – Digital Payments Safety Guidelines: <https://www.rbi.org.in>

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